United Methodist Homes
Skilled Nursing Home
Policy and Procedure

SUBJECT: CODE GREEN AND ELOPEMENT POLICY
REGULATION: OBRA: F655, F689, F740, F867, F943 PA: 211.10

POLICY STATEMENT:

It is the policy of United Methodist Homes to maintain knowledge of the general whereabouts of each resident and, in the event a resident is absent from the facility and the resident's whereabouts are unknown, efforts shall be taken to locate the resident.

DEFINITIONS:

"Code Green"- The emergency code used by the UMH to notify staff that a resident is missing and activate the emergency response protocol to conduct search.

"Happy Feet Club" – This is a program that select residents are entered into once they are identified as "at risk for elopement" Their resident representative and in-house physician is contacted, and their care plan is updated. A photo collage is hung at each of our public exits so that families and other residents know to be cautious if they see a resident whose face is present in our Happy Feet Club. These residents will also have a wander-guard pennant on either their person or their mobility device.

"Response Care System" – This is the system the facility utilizes to monitor our wander guard system. When a resident with a wander guard bracelet loiters near an exit door or passes the "tombstone" this would alarm on this system and would alarm in the nurses stations.

"Command Nurse" – Highest ranking nurse in the facility.

PROCEDURE:

1. In the event a resident's whereabouts are unknown, immediately notify the highest ranking nurse in the facility and this nurse will notify the DON, NHA, and ADON.
RESPONSIBILITY: All Staff

2. Review the resident's sign out sheet to ensure the resident has not been signed out.

RESPONSIBILITY: Licensed Nurse or Designee

3. Check to ensure the resident does not have any appointments scheduled during the time frame the resident is noted to be missing from the facility. If a simultaneous appointment, such as a physician or therapy appointment, is identified, contact the location of the appointment to verify if the resident is at the location.

RESPONSIBILITY: Licensed Nurse or Designee

4. Initiate a search of the immediate resident area, including areas known to be frequented by the resident and the unit on which the resident resides. In addition, if this resident is a member of our Happy Feet Club the Response Care System will be checked prior to calling a Code Green to help identify the residents last whereabouts.

RESPONSIBILITY: All Staff

5. If the resident's whereabouts remain unknown:
   a. Call "**Code Green**" immediately by utilizing the overhead page repeating Code Green 3x.
      [Pick up phone and push **5500** to initiate LOUD overhead page]
   b. The highest ranking nurse will make an announcement three times over the paging system as follows: "**Code Green, Mr. /Mrs./Ms. (Name), Please come to (unit name he/she lives on**)." That particular nurses unit will be considered the command center and is where staff should report to Command Nurse for assignment.

   c. The highest ranking nurse will organize a comprehensive search of the facility, grounds, and neighboring areas, assigning staff to check specific areas. This command nurse should remain in the command center.

   d. There are yellow tags located at each nurses station and at the receptionists desk. These tags will be used to identify that that specific area has been checked. Doors should remain open even after they are checked tagged (unlike orange fire tags)

RESPONSIBILITY: All Staff

6. If the resident's whereabouts remain unknown after 30 minutes, continue searching and:
   a. Notify other personnel as directed by the administrator and/or executive director.

RESPONSIBILITY: Licensed Nurse or Designee

   b. Contact the resident's representative

RESPONSIBILITY: DON, NHA, or ADON/Designee

   c. Notify local law enforcement and provide all pertinent details required.

RESPONSIBILITY: Administrator or Designee

   d. Provide law enforcement any assistance needed to formally notify and/or communicate with the resident's representative (responsible party).

RESPONSIBILITY: Administrator or Designee

7. Ensure the DOH is notified of reportable absences as required by regulation.
RESPONSIBILITY: Administrator or Designee

8. Ensure communication is maintained with the resident's representative, law enforcement, DOH, Ombudsman and UMH leadership while the search for the resident continues.
RESPONSIBILITY: Administrator or Designee

9. When the resident is located:

a. The designated individual will make an announcement three times over the facility over head paging system as follows: "**Code Green- all clear**" to notify staff. Repeat x3

b. Ensure all previously notified parties are updated that the resident has been located.

c. If the resident is located outside the facility by staff but refuses to return to the facility, remain with the resident and notify management immediately.

RESPONSIBILITY: Administrator or Designee

13. Upon return to the facility:

a. Conduct a full body assessment
b. Update the resident's primary medical provider and obtain new orders as indicated.
c. Review and revise the resident's plan of care as necessary.
d. If resident is not a member of the Happy Feet Club, conduct an elopement evaluation and follow policy (Add them to it.)
e. Immediately conduct a whole house census count of (heads in bed)
RESPONSIBILITY: Licensed Nurse/RN - assessment

14. Following an elopement an Incident Report will be opened to gather and review details surrounding the occurrence.

a. Review physical plant security systems in place to ensure systems are functioning appropriately.
b. Promptly modify systems/services as needed if issues or areas for improvement are identified. Back-up plan will be utilized while working on the system
c. Gather statements from all involved staff members
d. Reportable will be submitted to the DOH

RESPONSIILITY: DON/designee

15. Post elopement, IDT will review all documentation and statements and review/revise the care plan to update the reportable as necessary and help to complete the incident report

RESPONSIBILITY: Interdisciplinary Team

POLICY AND PROCEDURE: MISSING RESIDENT (CODE GREEN)
DATE: 05-01-2023

APPROVED BY:

_____ _____
Nursing Home Administrator Date

_____ _____
Director of Nursing Date

REVIEWED/REVISED:9/1/24